

# 1 Diagnostic

Your five-chapter structure is a recognizable and legitimate dissertation shape, but as it stands it reads closer to a long technical project report than a typical empirical master's dissertation. The gap isn't a missing chapter per se — it's a set of missing functions that dissertations are usually expected to perform, and which currently have no clear home in your structure.

Besides this, regarding the content, you should follow these strategies to fix transversal issues:

- **Reduce repetition and detail**, especially around “modular”, “SVG”, “OO”, and “layer-based” ideas. No need to be so detailed, neither show complete code implementations.
- **Tighten the literature review**, focusing more on critical analysis than textbook descriptions (no need for all those spectrogram/mel-spectrogram/log spectrogram etc.).
- **Perform a thorough English editing pass**, fixing grammar, articles, punctuation, and overly conversational phrasing

## 2 What's missing

### 2.1 Evaluation / Validation as a distinct concern

This is the big one. Right now, “validation” is a single example figure (Figure 4.2) embedded inside the implementation chapter, discussed in a “Side note.” For a master's dissertation, examiners usually look for a deliberate, structured answer to “how do I know this thing is any good?” — even for a tool/systems thesis where the contribution is the artifact itself.

The challenge is that LayerIt is a visualization framework, so you can't easily report accuracy numbers. But there are recognized ways to validate a tool contribution: a structured walkthrough of use cases showing the tool does what GUI tools can't, a comparison against the alternatives you criticized (SV, manual SVG cropping) on concrete dimensions, a small expert/user evaluation, or even a reflective “requirements vs. delivered” analysis. Your abstract already frames the BeatThis beat-tracking example as “a validation case” — that framing deserves to be a real section or chapter, not a side note.

### 2.2 Methodology / Approach

Empirical dissertations usually have a chapter explaining how the work was conducted and how it will be evaluated, stated before the results. Your “five iterations” narrative is genuinely interesting and is doing some methodological work (it's essentially an iterative/exploratory design process), but it's currently framed as project history rather than as a deliberate research method. Some examiners will want to see the research questions stated explicitly and the evaluation criteria defined up front.

### 2.3 Explicit research questions / objectives

The introduction motivates the work well, but I don't see crisply stated research questions or a numbered objectives list that the conclusion then maps back to. Your Chapter 5 “Achievements” list is good and does implicitly close several loops — but the loops were never explicitly opened in Chapter 1. Stating 1–3 RQs or objectives in the intro and answering them directly in the conclusion is a low-effort, high-credibility addition.

### 3 References

Complete the references in Zotero (a date accessed is only needed for web-page consultations, not for papers). Then export the library from Zotero — ideally together with the papers — and share the .bib file with me.

**Note** — *this is effort that pays off. A clean, complete .bib file is the single best way to avoid having to edit and correct the references by hand in LaTeX later on.*

### 4 Outros

- “Piano Precision” is not an acronym and should not be given one — and the same applies to “Sonic Visualiser”.
- Do not use links for acronyms. It makes the thesis difficult to read, filling the text with many things that look like links but aren’t.